Training Needs Analysis

Purpose - Benefits - Methods - Process

ASSIGNMENT 2 - 6N3325 - TRAINING NEEDS IDENTIFICATION AND DESIGN

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About the author

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  - A background in IT
  - Teaches programming: Python, C#, Java, JavaScript and AI
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- Education:
  - BSc in Computer Systems
  - MSc in Software Development

Introduction

- A TNA finds the gap between the performance needed and the performance we get[4]
- Training is one possible answer to that gap
- Today: why, benefits and limits, methods, stages

> My case: final year students doing their first large solo software project



[1] – Choose the course after the TNA, not before

Reasons for a TNA

- Organisation: goals, quality and legal duties
- Individual: the role, confidence and career
- A good TNA joins the two[6]

One question

What is the gap, and who has it?

Organisational reasons

- Performance: projects finished on time and to standard[6]
- Compliance: GDPR when students collect user data, and the AI policy[1]
- New technology: AI tools change how software is written

> Case: lectures teach the subject, not how to run a project. Past students lost work, took on too much and left the report to the end.

Individual reasons

- Skills gap: planning, backup and report writing
- Confidence: the first large solo project
- Career development: the project is the portfolio
- Motivation: adults learn what they see a need for[3]

Benefits and limitations

Organisation 6	Individual	Limitations 4
Targets real gaps	New skills	Staff time
Better use of resources	Confidence	Self-ratings can be wrong
Better results	Career	Resistance to change
Shows compliance	Job satisfaction	Goes out of date



2 – Without a TNA, the budget follows the shiny course

Methods compared

Method [5]	Best when	Weakness
Questionnaire and skills audit	Many people, fast, cheap	Must be tested, shallow
Interview	You need root causes	Slow, needs a skilled interviewer
Observation and documents	Little is known, or to check	People change when watched



[3] – Each method covers another's weakness

Stages in the TNA process

Stage [5]	Why it matters
1. Identify the purpose	Otherwise you collect the wrong data
2. Analyse organisation, task, individual	Training may not be the answer
3. Choose and test the methods	Untested questions give poor data
4. Collect the data	Evidence, not opinion
5. Analyse and prioritise	Time and money are limited
6. Recommend and plan	Findings become action
7. Evaluate [2]	Did it close the gap?

Stages in the TNA process

Subject: Survey of final year project students

Hi [programme lead],

For my Train the Trainer course I am doing a training needs analysis on the final year project. May I send final year students a 10-minute anonymous survey? It is voluntary, collects no names or student numbers and is not linked to grades. I would also like 15 minutes with two or three supervisors. Results are stored securely and deleted after [date].

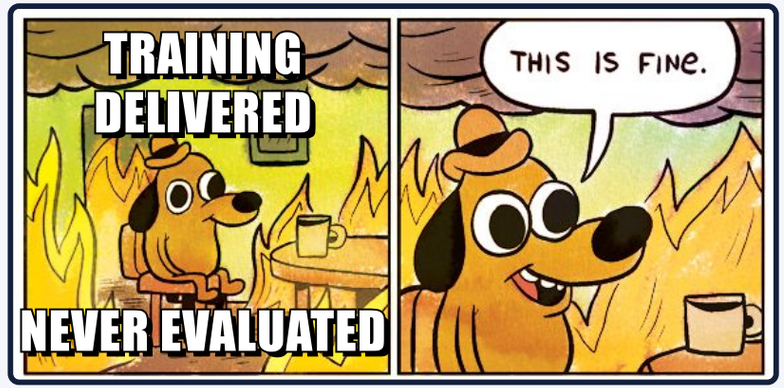
Thanks, Mark

Stage 1 in practice: ask management first, and plan for GDPR from the start 1

Conclusion

- Start with the gap, not the course
- Use more than one method
- Link the findings to goals at both levels
- Evaluate, or you never know if it worked[2]

> Next for my case: run the survey, then design the training to close the gaps it finds



[4] – Skip evaluation and nobody knows if it worked

Questions?



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References

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6. Noe, R.A. (2023) Employee training and development. 9th edn. New York: McGraw Hill.

Media used

1. KYM Drakeposting. Stills from Hotline Bling, Drake (2015). Template from imgflip.
2. KYM Distracted boyfriend. Stock photo by Antonio Guillem (2015). Template from imgflip.
3. KYM Galaxy brain (expanding brain). Anonymous (2017). Template from imgflip.
4. KYM This is fine. KC Green, Gunshow, "On Fire" (2013). Template from imgflip.

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